Daily Content Intel

June 23, 2026

Topic A — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, here's a study I want every lacrosse and football player to hear about. Researchers tracked 19 guys on the British national sixes lacrosse team for 9 months, through tournaments, a US training camp, and the World Games, and before any of it they measured how strong each player's legs were with a mid-thigh pull, basically how much force you can put into the ground relative to your bodyweight.

Then they watched who got hurt. And the players who could produce more force per kilo of bodyweight got hurt a lot less. For every 1 newton per kilo of extra strength, the risk of a non-contact injury, your hamstring strains, your sprains, dropped by 67%. The slow-build overload stuff, the tendon problems, dropped by 33%.

So strength does more than make you faster off the line or win you a ground ball. It's armor too. The stronger your legs are relative to your size, the more your body can absorb when you plant, cut, and decelerate.

They even gave a target to chase, above 31.3 newtons per kilo on that test. You don't need the test to use this, right? The Monday takeaway is simple. Get your legs strong. Trap bar deadlift, split squat, hard posterior chain work, progressed over months, not crammed into a week.

Strong legs are durable legs. That's the play.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: Stronger legs, fewer injuries. Lacrosse just put a number on it.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, here's a study I want every lacrosse and football player to hear about. Researchers tracked 19 guys on the British national sixes lacrosse team for 9 months, through tournaments, a US training camp, and the World Games, and before any of it they measured how strong each player's legs were with a mid-thigh pull, basically how much force you can put into the ground relative to your bodyweight.

Then they watched who got hurt. And the players who could produce more force per kilo of bodyweight got hurt a lot less. For every 1 newton per kilo of extra strength, the risk of a non-contact injury, your hamstring strains, your sprains, dropped by 67%. The slow-build overload stuff, the tendon problems, dropped by 33%.

So strength does more than make you faster off the line or win you a ground ball. It's armor too. The stronger your legs are relative to your size, the more your body can absorb when you plant, cut, and decelerate.

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Strong legs are durable legs. That's the play.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 Stronger legs = fewer injuries
- 0:08 9-month study, British national sixes lacrosse
- 0:18 Measured leg strength: force per kg of bodyweight
- 0:30 +1 N/kg strength = noncontact injury risk down 67%
- 0:38 Overload / tendon injury risk down 33%
- 0:50 Strength is armor: absorbs the plant, cut, decelerate

- 1:02 Target: above 31.3 N/kg on the mid-thigh pull
- 1:10 Monday: trap bar, split squat, posterior chain, progressed
- 1:20 Strong legs are durable legs

Caption (copy-paste ready):

Stronger legs, fewer injuries. A 9-month study on the British national sixes lacrosse team measured each player's leg strength before the season, then tracked who got hurt. The stronger players, force-per-kilo of bodyweight, got hurt far less. Every 1 N/kg of extra relative strength cut non-contact injury risk by 67% and overload injury risk by 33%. Speed and ground balls are the bonus. Durability is the point. Get the legs strong and progress it over months, not days. It's time to cross your threshold. Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT. Book: threshold.clientsecure.me #lacrosse #lacrossetraining #footballtraining #strengthandconditioning #sportsperformance #injuryprevention #athletedevelopment #returntosport #strengthtraining #physicaltherapy

Personalize this

- You program HS football and work a NoVA football plus club-lacrosse audience. Which of your athletes would actually clear a 31.3 N/kg type strength standard, and who's nowhere close? Name the gap you see between your strongest kids and the ones who keep tweaking hamstrings.
- What's your go-to lower-body strength progression for an in-season lacrosse middie who can't add much volume? How do you keep their legs durable without frying them before a game weekend?
- Where does "strong legs are armor" sit inside your CROSS framework and the Threshold pitch to a parent who's scared that lifting will make their kid slow or bulky?

Screenshots:

- title | https://doi.org/10.1519/JSC.0000000000005476 | "Protective Effect of Lower Limb Strength on Lower Limb Injuries Within International Sixes Lacrosse Players: A Nine-Month Prospective Study"

- physiology | https://www.strengthscience.co/p/stronger-legs-fewer-injuries-lacrosse | "For every 1 N/kg increase in relative strength, the risk of a noncontact injury dropped by 67% and the risk of an overload injury dropped by 33%."
- actionable | https://www.strengthscience.co/p/stronger-legs-fewer-injuries-lacrosse | "The researchers recommend targeting a relative net peak force above 31.3 N/kg on the IMTP."

Sources:

- https://doi.org/10.1519/JSC.0000000000005476
- https://www.strengthscience.co/p/stronger-legs-fewer-injuries-lacrosse

Topic B — Reel

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Okay, hot take for the football and soccer coaches. If you're running your guys through these massive Nordic hamstring sessions, 30 plus reps, a few times a week, you're probably burning their legs and their buy-in for no extra payoff.

Here's why I say that. A randomized trial put elite female footballers into two groups for 8 weeks. One group did the full evidence-based Nordic program, 538 total reps. The other group did a stripped-down version, 144 reps, less than a third of the work.

Both groups got stronger. Eccentric hamstring strength went up about the same in both, with no meaningful difference between them. The low-volume group bought the same protective strength gain for a quarter of the volume.

And this matters in the real world, because fewer than 1 in 5 teams actually finish the full high-volume program. It's brutal, athletes skip it, and a program that's too punishing to finish doesn't protect anyone.

So here's what I'd run. Two sets of 4 to 6 hard Nordics, once or twice a week, progressed slowly. That's it. The hamstrings get the same armor, your athletes actually stick with it, and you free up the rest of the session for sprinting.

You get the protection for a quarter of the work. Take the deal.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: Your 30-rep Nordic sessions are overkill. The trial proved it.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, hot take for the football and soccer coaches. If you're running your guys through these massive Nordic hamstring sessions, 30 plus reps, a few times a week, you're probably burning their legs and their buy-in for no extra payoff.

Here's why I say that. A randomized trial put elite female footballers into two groups for 8 weeks. One group did the full evidence-based Nordic program, 538 total reps. The other group did a stripped-down version, 144 reps, less than a third of the work.

Both groups got stronger. Eccentric hamstring strength went up about the same in both, with no meaningful difference between them. The low-volume group bought the same protective strength gain for a quarter of the volume.

And this matters in the real world, because fewer than 1 in 5 teams actually finish the full high-volume program. It's brutal, athletes skip it, and a program that's too punishing to finish doesn't protect anyone.

So here's what I'd run. Two sets of 4 to 6 hard Nordics, once or twice a week, progressed slowly. That's it. The hamstrings get the same armor, your athletes actually stick with it, and you free up the rest of the session for sprinting.

You get the protection for a quarter of the work. Take the deal.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 Your 30-rep Nordic sessions are overkill
- 0:10 8-week randomized trial, elite female footballers
- 0:20 High volume: 538 total reps
- 0:26 Low volume: 144 reps (under a third)
- 0:36 Same eccentric strength gain, no real difference
- 0:48 Reality: under 1 in 5 teams finish the big program
- 0:58 A program too brutal to finish protects no one

- 1:06 Run it: 2x4-6 Nordics, 1-2x/week, progressed
- 1:18 Same protection, a quarter of the work

Caption (copy-paste ready):

The big Nordic hamstring sessions are overkill. An 8-week randomized trial split elite female footballers into a full evidence-based program at 538 total reps and a stripped-down version at 144 reps. Both groups gained the same eccentric hamstring strength, with no meaningful difference. The kicker: fewer than 1 in 5 teams ever finish the high-volume version, so a brutal program ends up protecting no one. Run 2 sets of 4 to 6 hard Nordics, once or twice a week, progressed slowly, and put the saved time into sprinting. Train smart. It's time to cross your threshold. Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT. Book: threshold.clientsecure.me #nordichamstring #hamstringinjury #footballtraining #soccertraining #strengthandconditioning #injuryprevention #sportsscience #athletedevelopment #speedtraining #physicaltherapy

Personalize this

- How do you actually dose Nordics for your HS football guys right now? Have you hit the same compliance wall the study describes, where athletes quietly bail on the long eccentric days?
- Tell a hamstring story from your practice, one you rehabbed or kept from happening. Did piling on eccentric volume help, or did something lower and smarter do the job?
- Where does this land inside the Threshold idea of training smart, not just hard? What's your line for the coach or parent who's sure more reps always means more protection?

Screenshots:

- title | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11022781/ | "Effects of High and Low Training Volume with the Nordic Hamstring Exercise on Hamstring Strength, Jump Height, and Sprint Performance in Female Football Players: A Randomised Trial"

- physiology | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11022781/ | "Both groups increased maximal eccentric force (high-volume: 29 N (10%), 95% CI: 19–38 N, $p < 0.001$, low-volume: 37 N (13%), 95% CI: 18–55 N, $p = 0.001$), but there were no between-group differences ($p = 0.38$)."
- actionable | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11022781/ | "Our findings demonstrate that a low-volume Nordic hamstring exercise programme is equally effective as the evidence-based high-volume programme in increasing eccentric hamstring strength among female elite football players."

Sources:

- https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11022781/

Reference

Runner-up topics

- Rate of force development as the missing link between heavy lifting and sprint speed (needs a verifiable primary, not the content-farm writeup found today).
- Elite adolescent athlete data: hitting 8+ hours sleep cut injury risk 61%, meeting nutrition guidelines cut it 64% (Swedish youth athlete cohort) — strong athlete-first teaching reel.
- IMTP relative strength and jump performance in elite youth female soccer players (PMC12266006) as a companion to today's Draft A.

Sources scanned today

- Newsletter digest (newsletter_digest_2026-06-23.pdf): all promotional. Dr. Mercola (eye-health ad) and two Mike T. Nelson Flex Diet Certification sales emails. Nothing substantive to extract.
- PubMed / JSCR: found the fresh primary for Draft A, "Protective Effect of Lower

Limb Strength on Lower Limb Injuries Within International Sixes Lacrosse Players" (J Strength Cond Res, published June 4, 2026, Ripley/Collier/Fahey/Comfort, University of Salford).

- Strength Science (Danny James newsletter): digestible writeup of the lacrosse strength study with the effect sizes and the 31.3 N/kg target.
- PubMed / Translational Sports Medicine: Amundsen et al. 2022 randomized trial on high vs low training volume Nordic hamstring exercise in elite female footballers (PMC11022781), used for Draft B.
- Searched RFD / sprint-speed transfer: the most-cited 2026 result only surfaced on a content-farm page (accio.com) with claims I could not verify against a primary, so I dropped that angle.
- Dedup: checked cited-sources.json. Neither draft's URLs appear in the registry. Recent blocked families (hamstring EMG, deceleration ACL,

plyometrics, sled sprint, creatine) were avoided.